# Chapter 1: Introduction to Styles

**Comprehensive Theory, Complete Practical Procedures & Exam Solutions (Session 2026-2027)**

## 1. Meaning and Advantages of Styles

A **Style** in LibreOffice Writer is a named collection of formatting features and attributes (such as font face, size, colour, text alignment, indents, borders, tab stops, and spacing) that can be applied to different document components to control their appearance and layout consistently.

**Core Advantages of Using Styles:**

- **Consistent and Professional Layout:** Ensures all headings, body text, lists, and tables maintain uniform formatting throughout the document.
- **Time-Saving Formatting:** Enables applying multiple formatting properties in a single action rather than adjusting individual formatting options repeatedly.
- **Global Automatic Updates:** Modifying a style automatically updates every single paragraph or object linked with that style across the entire document.
- **Foundation for Advanced Document Features:** Heading styles are essential to automatically generate and evaluate a Table of Contents (ToC).

## 2. Six Style Categories in LibreOffice Writer

LibreOffice Writer provides exactly **six** distinct categories of styles, managed through the Styles Deck / Sidebar:

| Style Category | Scope & Associated Properties | Practical Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Paragraph Style** | Controls the formatting of an entire paragraph, including line spacing, text alignment, indents, tab stops, margins, borders, and default text appearance. | Heading 1, Heading 2, Body Text, Title, Subtitle |
| **2. Character Style** | Applies formatting to highlighted text, specific words, or single characters within a paragraph without affecting paragraph-level layout. | Emphasis, Strong Emphasis, Subscript, Superscript |
| **3. Page Style** | Controls overall page structure, including page size, margins, page orientation (portrait/landscape), headers, footers, borders, and page numbering. | Default Page Style, Landscape, Envelope, First Page |
| **4. Frame Style** | Defines the layout, borders, background, wrap settings, and padding of frames, text boxes, and graphic elements with attached captions. | Graphics, Frame, Formula, Labels, Marginalia |
| **5. List Style** | Controls bullet shapes, numbering types, multilevel numbering indentation, alignment, and prefix/suffix characters for lists. | Numbering 123, Bullet •, Alphabet a b c, List 1 |
| **6. Table Style** | Applies predefined structural and visual formats to tables, header rows, alternate row shading (zebra striping), and border designs. | Default Style, Academic, Box List Blue, Elegant |

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## 3. Opening and Accessing the Styles Deck

The Styles window/deck is a dockable panel in LibreOffice Writer used to browse, apply, create, and manage styles. It can be opened using any of the following methods:

- **Keyboard Shortcut:** Press `F11` (or `Alt + 2`).
- **Menu Bar (LibreOffice Standard):** Choose **Styles > Manage Styles** (or **View > Styles**).
- **Menu Bar (OpenOffice / Legacy Pattern):** Choose **Format > Styles and Formatting**.
- **Sidebar:** Click the **Styles** icon (A with a spark/deck icon) on the right sidebar.

> **CBSE Question Paper Note:** In previous examinations, CBSE accepted *Format* menu as well as *Styles* menu for opening the Styles and Formatting panel. When asked to write the steps in subjective questions, it is recommended to state: *"Select Styles > Manage Styles (or Format > Styles and Formatting / Press F11)"* to ensure complete evaluation alignment.

## 4. Comparative Analysis: Fill Format Mode vs. Clone Formatting

| Attribute | Fill Format Mode | Clone Formatting (Format Painter) |
|---|---|---|
| **Purpose** | Applies a **named style** (predefined or custom) to multiple scattered, non-contiguous sections of a document quickly. | Copies **direct / manual formatting** from selected text and paints it onto target text. |
| **Location & Icon** | Located in the **Styles Deck** panel (`F11`); represented by an ink-can / fill-pot icon. | Located on the **Standard Toolbar**; represented by a paint-roller / paint-brush icon (`Ctrl + Shift + C`). |
| **How to Cancel** | Press the `Esc` key or click the Fill Format Mode icon again. | Press `Esc` or click the tool button again. |
| **Special Action** | **Right-clicking** while Fill Format Mode is active cancels/undoes the previous fill action without quitting the mode. | Single-click applies formatting once; double-clicking keeps tool active for multiple clicks. |

## 5. Complete Step-by-Step Practical Procedures

### A. Applying a Style to a Document Object

1. Select the text, paragraph, frame, page, or table you wish to format.
2. Open the Styles deck by pressing `F11` or selecting **Styles > Manage Styles**.
3. Click on the appropriate category icon at the top of the Styles deck (e.g., *Paragraph Styles* or *Character Styles*).
4. Scroll through the list to locate the desired style name.
5. **Double-click** the style name to apply it to the selected object.

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### B. Using Fill Format Mode

1. Open the Styles deck (`F11`).
2. Select the style category and click once on the style you want to apply.
3. Click the **Fill Format Mode** icon (ink-pot icon) located at the top-right of the Styles deck. The mouse pointer changes to a fill-can cursor.
4. Apply the style:
   - For a paragraph, page, or frame: Click directly on the target object.
   - For a character style: Click and drag across the required text, or click a single word.
5. Continue clicking on all scattered sections where the style is needed.
6. To exit Fill Format Mode, press `Esc` on the keyboard or click the *Fill Format Mode* icon again. (Note: Right-clicking while in this mode undoes the last fill action).

### C. Creating a New Style from Selection

1. Format the text, paragraph, or frame manually with the desired attributes (font, size, colour, indents, borders).
2. Highlight the formatted text/object.
3. Open the Styles deck (`F11`).
4. Select the style category icon under which the new style should be created (e.g., Paragraph Styles).
5. Click the arrow next to the **Style Actions / New Style** icon at the top-right corner of the Styles deck.
6. Select **New Style from Selection** from the drop-down menu.
7. In the *Create Style* dialog box, type a meaningful name for the new style.
8. Click **OK**. The new style is added to the list and is saved in the document.

### D. Creating a Style Using Drag and Drop

1. Format the required paragraph or text in your document.
2. Open the Styles deck (`F11`) and ensure the correct category is selected.
3. Select the formatted text in the document.
4. Click and hold the left mouse button on the selection, then drag the mouse pointer directly into the Styles deck area and release the button.
5. In the *Create Style* pop-up dialog box, type the name for the new style and click **OK**.

### E. Updating an Existing Style from Selection

1. Select the paragraph or text that already uses the style and has been modified with new formatting.
2. Open the Styles deck (`F11`).
3. Highlight the existing style name in the list that you wish to update.
4. Click the arrow next to the **Style Actions** icon.
5. Click **Update Selected Style** (or press `Ctrl + Shift + F11`).
6. The style definition updates immediately, and **all paragraphs or elements using this style throughout the document update automatically**.

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### F. Loading Styles from a Template or Document

1. Open the destination document where you want to import styles.
2. Open the Styles deck (`F11`).
3. Click the arrow next to the **Style Actions** icon and choose **Load Styles from Template**.
4. In the *Load Styles* dialog box, choose the template containing the styles you need. (To copy from another document file, click the **From File...** button, locate the file, and click *Open*).
5. Select the checkboxes for the style categories to import (*Text, Frame, Pages, Numbering*).
6. Check the **Overwrite** box if you want imported styles to replace existing styles with the same name.
7. Click **OK**.

## 6. Board Examination Question Bank with Model Answers

**Q1. Ramesh wants to apply a specific paragraph style to multiple non-contiguous sections of his document. Which feature of LibreOffice Writer should he use to avoid manually applying the style each time? How can he stop using it? [1 Mark - CBSE 2024 / SQP 2026]**

**Ans:** He should use the **Fill Format Mode**. He can stop using it by pressing the `Esc` key on the keyboard or by clicking the *Fill Format Mode* icon again.

**Q2. Which style category in LibreOffice Writer is used to define layout elements such as margins, headers, and footers? [1 Mark - Board PYQ Set 4]**

**Ans: Page Style**.

**Q3. Differentiate between "New Style from Selection" and "Update Selected Style". [2 Marks - Board Standard]**

**Ans:** *New Style from Selection* creates a completely separate, newly named style definition based on the formatting of the currently selected text. *Update Selected Style* modifies an existing style definition to match new formatting changes, automatically updating all existing text in the document that uses that style.

**Q4. What is the significance of the "Overwrite" option when loading styles into a document? [2 Marks - CBSE Model]**

**Ans:** In the Load Styles dialog box, checking the **Overwrite** option ensures that any style in the active document having the exact same name as an incoming style is replaced by the imported style's formatting. If unchecked, conflicting existing styles remain unchanged.

**Q5. Differentiate between Character Style and Paragraph Style with examples. [2 Marks - CBSE SQP]**

**Ans:** A **Paragraph Style** applies formatting to the entire paragraph, including layout settings like line spacing, text alignment, indents, and tab stops (e.g., *Heading 1*, *Body Text*). A **Character Style** applies formatting only to highlighted words or characters within a paragraph without altering paragraph layout (e.g., *Emphasis*, *Strong Emphasis*).

**Q6. Explain the steps to load styles from another file in LibreOffice Writer. [4 Marks - Descriptive Type]**

**Ans:**

1. Open the target document and open the Styles deck by pressing `F11`.
2. Click the *Style Actions* dropdown arrow and select **Load Styles from Template**.
3. In the Load Styles dialog, click the **From File...** button.
4. Navigate to the folder containing the source document, select the file, and click **Open**.
5. Select the required category checkboxes (*Text, Frame, Pages, Numbering*).
6. Check the **Overwrite** checkbox if you want to replace same-named styles, and click **OK**.

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